

Behavioral Coaching: Examples



Step	Fitness Professional Example	Football Coach Example
1. Carefully define the desired behaviors.	The following example would be provided in written form to a personal training client. Four Steps to a Push-up: • Begin in prone-iso-abs (plank) position with arms fully extended. • While maintaining the integrity of the posture, lower yourself to the floor by flexing the elbow joint. • Pause when your chest is within 3 inches of the floor. • Extend the elbows and return to the starting position.	The following example would be provided in written form to a football player. Four Steps in the Beginning of a Block: • Hands rest on knees in a ready position. • Initial step is taken with the foot closest to the defender. • Drive out of the stance, taking short initial steps to the target. • Bring arms up and forward, aiming at the chest of the target.
2. Execute the play.	Fitness Professional: “When I say ‘Go,’ I want you to begin the push-up. If you do not maintain proper form and technique, I’m going to tell you to ‘freeze.’ This means stop exactly in the position that you are in when you hear ‘freeze’ and don’t move until I tell you. I’m going to evaluate what is going on so that I can help you maintain the integrity of the form and you can perform a better push-up. If you are doing it right, I won’t tell you to ‘freeze.’ Okay?”	Football Coach: “When I blow this whistle, I want you to block your opponents. If you screw up, I’m going to tell you to ‘freeze.’ This means stop exactly in the position that you are in when you hear the whistle and don’t move until I tell you. That applies to everyone. When you hear the whistle, stop in your tracks. I’m going to see what you’re doing wrong so that I can help you block better. If you do it right, I’ll let you know and you won’t have to freeze. Okay?”
3. Judge the correct executions.	Fitness Professional: “Great technique on your push-up. You have really improved on your stability.”	Football Coach: “Great blocking, John. Your technique has improved.”
4. Describe the incorrect executions.	Fitness Professional: “Your push-up is being completed too quickly. Make sure to take your time and slowly lower yourself to within 3 inches of the floor for four seconds, hold that position for two seconds, and take one second to raise yourself back to the starting point.”	Football Coach: “John, you can get faster. That play was too slow.”

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5. Model the correct execution.	The fitness professional will perform the appropriate execution of the push-up and provide appropriate cueing to adjust the client for better execution. The client should also be complimented on aspects of the exercise they are performing correctly.	The coach will demonstrate the best way to execute a block.
6. Imitate the correct execution.	Fitness Professional: The fitness professional talks the client through the right positioning. The fitness professional might say, "Try to feel the tightness in your muscles. Notice that by squeezing your gluteals, you are able to maintain the rigid position we are looking for. Now everything is in proper alignment for performing the push-up!"	Football Coach: "Try to feel the pattern in your muscles. Notice that now you have a really stable base. That's a good position to keep your opponent from throwing your block."